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r/UXDesign digest - Tuesday, May 26, 2026

1 message

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WEEKDAY DIGEST · TUESDAY, MAY 26, 2026

r/UXDesign

The top five posts from r/UXDesign in the last 24 hours, distilled for scanning and readability.

TL;DR

A grumpy day on r/UXDesign, with skepticism toward truisms about design, chat-as-AI-interface and the European job market.

- "Design is solving problems" lands flat without an AI angle
- Chat interfaces feel like the new command line, but no one knows what replaces them
- Non-designers can't tell good portfolios from bad ones
- New hires warned against playing critic in their first weeks
- Europe's UX job market looks brutal for outsiders

01 🌶️

Design is solving a problem. That's all it is

262 · SCORE ↑

48 · COMMENTS

A link post arguing design boils down to problem-solving, full stop. The comments don't buy the framing. The top reply notes the piece doesn't mention AI once and calls it BS, which says a lot about where the sub's head is right now. The second-highest comment points out that "solving problems" describes basically every job, so the definition is too broad to be useful. The thread reads as a collective eye-roll at design platitudes that don't account for how the work is actually changing. Worth knowing because it shows the appetite for tidy first-principles posts has dropped sharply when they ignore the AI shift everyone is living through.

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02 🌶️

Is chat actually the right interface for AI-native software?

51 · SCORE ↑

43 · COMMENTS

OP compares ChatGPT-style chat to the 80s command line and wonders what the real AI-native interface looks like, floating persistent assistants, AI operating systems or something with no good metaphor yet. The top comment, with 86 points, pushes hard against natural language itself, calling it too vague and slow and arguing it disconnects users from the task. That commenter wants AI to disappear behind the scenes, like spellcheck or noise canceling, so users stay in control instead of spinning a "token roulette." The second-highest reply is just "bro..." which captures the sub's patience for big-think AI posts. The interesting tension is between OP's "what comes after chat" framing and the top commenter's argument that the answer is less visible AI, not a new chrome. Worth reading for the pushback against natural language as the default AI interface.

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How do I hire a UI/UX freelancer when I don't have a sense for what good UI/UX is?

9 · SCORE ↑

35 · COMMENTS

A developer with an LLM-slop MVP is trying to hire a UX freelancer on Upwork and can't tell a \$15/hr portfolio from a \$30/hr one. He's filtering on instinct, avoiding LLM-written proposals and preferring Figma links over screenshots. The most useful comment argues a good designer should be able to explain UX in language the client understands, not designer jargon, which is a clean heuristic for non-designers hiring. Another commenter flatly says both rates are too low and that real freelancers start at \$75 an hour. A mod comment also notes job posts aren't allowed in the sub. Worth knowing for the price-floor signal and the communication test, both of which are practical filters anyone hiring outside their expertise can use.

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04

Start my new job this week!!! Any advice for making a good impression?

5 · SCORE ↑

3 · COMMENTS

A designer landing a job after a five-month search asks how to make a good impression at a 150-person company with four designers. The advice is short and sane. Enjoy the first few weeks because it's usually the most chill stretch of the job. Ask a lot of questions about how the team works and what the company sells. The sharpest piece of advice warns against pointing out what's "wrong" with process or Figma file management early on, because there's usually a reason things are the way they are, the team probably already knows and a new hire flagging it looks like a smartass move. Useful because it pushes against the

instinct to prove value by critiquing.

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05 

How to best set myself up for a career in Europe?

4 · SCORE ↑

25 · COMMENTS

A 24-year-old Australian interaction design student wants to relocate to Europe and is weighing a Masters in the Netherlands or Germany, a working holiday visa or applying cold once he has experience. The top reply is bleak. UX isn't a high-demand profession in the EU, the job market is rough for foreigners who don't speak the local language and non-EU students in the Netherlands can only work 16 hours a week, which doesn't cover €1,000-plus rent. The commenter warns not to come without housing locked in months ahead. The second comment argues physical presence matters more than the Masters itself and that a strong portfolio carries more weight than the credential. Worth knowing because it's a clear-eyed counterweight to the "study abroad will open doors" pitch a lot of students hear.

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THEMES TODAY

The thread today is skeptical, almost weary. Posts that traffic in clean abstractions, "design is solving problems," "what comes after chat," "study abroad to get a job," get met with commenters dragging the conversation back to specifics: AI is reshaping the work, natural language might be the wrong interface, the EU job market is brutal for outsiders. The signal underneath is that the sub wants concrete answers, not framings.

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